

MICHELE VALINOTI

NEW YORK UNIVERSITY

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Education

PhD and MPhil in Economics , , New York University, USA	2020 – 2026 (expected)
MA in Economics , <i>Allievi Honors Program</i> , Collegio Carlo Alberto, Italy	2015 – 2019
MSc in Stochastics and Data Science , <i>cum laude</i> , University of Turin, Italy	2017 – 2019
BSc in Physics , <i>University of Turin, Italy</i> , <i>cum laude</i>	2014 – 2017

Research and Professional Experience

Jun – Aug 2025	Uber , PhD Scientist Intern (Membership Team). <i>San Francisco, USA</i>
May 2024 – Jan 2025	NYU , Research Assistant for Prof. Bryant Moy (NYU, Politics). <i>New York, USA</i>
May 2022 – Aug 2023	NBER , Research Assistant for Prof. Giulia Brancaccio (NYU Stern, Economics) & Prof. Karam Kang (UW-Madison, Economics). <i>New York, USA</i>
Jan – July 2020	European Central Bank , Risk Analyst Intern. <i>Frankfurt, Germany</i>

Teaching Experience

Fall 2025	Money & Banking (UG), NYU, Course Assistant
Spring 2024 – 2025	Statistics (UG), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2023 – 2024	Math for Economists (MA), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Summer 2024 – 2024	Industrial Organization (UG), NYU, Course Assistant
Spring 2023	Microeconomics (MA), NYU, Teaching Assistant
Fall 2022	Game Theory (PHD), NYU, Course Assistant

Awards and Scholarships

2020–2025	Henry Mitchell MacCracken Fellowship, NYU
2023	CV Starr Center for Applied Economics Data Purchase Support, NYU
2016–2019	Allievi Honors Program Scholarship, Collegio Carlo Alberto

Skills

Coding: Python (*pandas*, *scikit-learn*, *PyTorch*, *Hugging Face*), Julia, R, SQL, MATLAB

Tools: Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, PySpark

Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent)

Research Projects

Intermediation in Matching Markets: Evidence from Commercial Lobbying

This paper studies the role of intermediaries in the allocation of political access. Using novel data on lobbying contacts between clients, lobbying firms, and lawmakers in New York State, I document three key empirical facts: (i) legislative influence, committee assignment, and seniority are strong predictors of contact volume; (ii) commercial lobbyists are significantly more active than in-house lobbyists, particularly when connected to lawmakers via campaign contributions or prior employment; and (iii) connections are used selectively, even after conditioning on issue-area alignment and agent identities. Building on these facts, I propose a model in which lobbying firms and clients negotiate fees as a function of firm-specific characteristics and expected returns. The model embeds a matching mechanism that allocates contacts to lawmakers in a manner that maximizes client welfare subject to two equilibrium constraints: a market-clearing condition equating supply and demand for contacts, and a participation condition linking lobbying effort to negotiated fees. The framework rationalizes observed contact patterns and provides a foundation for estimating counterfactual allocations under alternative intermediation structures.

Criminal Activity Nuisance Ordinance (CANO) Database (with Bryant Moy and Moin Khan)

We construct the first comprehensive national database of Criminal Activity Nuisance Ordinances (CANOs), a class of municipal laws that penalize property owners for repeated police interactions. The database is built through a multi-stage process that combines large-scale web scraping of municipal codes from major legal repositories with targeted manual collection from city websites. We define a CANO using a legally grounded typology based on language linking resident behavior to owner liability. To classify ordinances at scale, we apply large language models to identify relevant provisions: the resulting dataset covers thousands of municipalities and captures both the presence of CANOs and the legal features that characterize their intensity. This infrastructure supports new empirical work on the prevalence and design of discriminatory local policies.

Women, Media and Politics (with Sahar Parsa)

This paper investigates the persistent gender disparities in media coverage of political candidates in the United States from 1980 to 2021. Using a novel dataset that combines detailed electoral records with over one million newspaper articles, we provide a comprehensive analysis of how female and male candidates are represented in the media during election campaigns for congressional, gubernatorial, and mayoral offices. We document three key findings. First, women candidates consistently receive more media coverage than their male counterparts. Second, using coreference resolution and state-of-the-art sentence transformers, we show that the qualitative content and tone of coverage differ systematically by gender, even after controlling for incumbency, vote share, and office type. In a third next step, we decompose the differences between the embedding representations among semantic, topic and style choices of their respective publishers.

References

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Professor Martin Rotemberg
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